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Lead Service Architect (Ref: 22312)

Ministry of Justice

Apply before 11:55 pm on Wednesday 30th September 2026

Ministry of
JUSTICE

Reference number

481555

Salary

£71,381 - £85,257

The national salary range is £71,381 - £80,419, London salary range is £75,674 - £85,257. Your salary will be dependent on your base location

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 6

Grade 6

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

East Midlands (England), East of England, London (region), North East England, North West England, Scotland, South East England, South West England, Wales, West Midlands (England), Yorkshire and the Humber

About the job

Job summary

This position is based Nationally

Job description

Lead Service Architect

Location: National*

Closing Date: 30th September

Interviews: W/C 12th October (subject to change)

Grade: G6

(MoJ candidates who are on a specialist grade, will be able to retain this grade on lateral transfer)

Salary: London - £75,674 to £85,257. **National** - £71,381 to £80,419.

Working pattern: Full-time, Part-time, Flexible working, Job share

Contract Type: Permanent

Number of vacancies: 1

Vacancy number: 21220

***We offer a hybrid working model, allowing for a balance between remote work and time spent in your local office. Office locations can be found [ON THIS MAP](#)**

The Role

Please note this role requires you to pass [Security Check](#) clearance. Please click on the [link](#) for details.

We're recruiting for a Lead Service Architect here at Justice Digital, Data and Science to be part of our warm and collaborative Technology Services Delivery (TSD) team.

As Lead Service Architect, you will provide strategic leadership for Service Architecture across Technology Services. You will shape how services are defined, designed and continually improved, ensuring a consistent and effective approach across a complex technology landscape.

You will act as the professional lead for Service Architecture, setting the direction for the profession and promoting consistent standards, methods and ways of working across Technology Services. You will build professional capability through mentoring, coaching and communities of practice rather than through direct line management responsibility.

You will work across multiple services, programmes and delivery teams, providing leadership and assurance on complex or high-risk initiatives. You will influence strategic decisions, create frameworks and guidance, and ensure that services are designed with operational sustainability, user needs and organisational priorities in mind.

You will also lead and own the Technology Services service portfolio and service catalogue, helping establish a clear and consistent view of services, ownership, dependencies and service performance across the organisation.

You'll receive a range of excellent benefits when you join our department, including:

A generous employer pension contribution of 28.97% through the Civil Service Pension Scheme.

25 days of annual leave, (increasing to 30 days once you have reached 5 years of service), plus 8 bank holidays and a privilege day for the King's birthday.

Flexible working arrangements including hybrid working, working part time or compressed hours. Designed to support a positive work-life balance.

Employees are allocated **10% of their working time for personal and professional development.**

A £1k per person learning budget is in place to support all our people, with access to best-in-class conferences and seminars, accreditation with professional bodies, fully funded vocational programmes and e-learning platforms.

Compassionate maternity, adoption, and shared parental leave policies, with up to 26 weeks leave at full pay, 13 weeks with partial pay, and 13 weeks further leave. And maternity support/paternity leave at full pay for 2 weeks, too!

You can find more details of the Benefits we offer [here](#). To help picture your life at [MoJ Justice Digital, Data and Science](#) please take a look at our [blog](#).

Key Responsibilities

Profession Leadership

Act as the professional lead for Service Architecture across Technology Services.

Establish and maintain the Service Architecture community of practice.

Define professional standards, expectations and good practice for Service Architects.

Coach, mentor and support Service Architects across Technology Services.

Promote the value and importance of Service Architecture with senior leaders, delivery teams and operational teams.

Represent Technology Services in cross-government and cross-profession forums.

Strategy and Direction

Define and maintain the Service Architecture strategy and roadmap for Technology Services.

Shape how Service Architecture supports Technology Services strategic priorities and service outcomes.

Identify opportunities to improve service design and operational readiness practices.

Ensure service architecture approaches remain aligned with government and industry best practice.

Contribute to wider technology, service management and operating model strategies.

Service Portfolio and Catalogue Management

Lead the development, governance and continual improvement of the

Technology Services service portfolio and service catalogue.

Establish and maintain a consistent approach to service definition, service ownership and service structure across Technology Services.

Develop standards and guidance to ensure service information remains accurate, accessible and aligned across the organisation.

Establish and maintain the service architecture framework, service model and supporting artefacts used across Technology Services.

Use service portfolio and catalogue information to support governance, investment decisions, demand management and strategic planning.

Promote a service-based view of Technology Services, improving visibility of services, dependencies, service health and opportunities for improvement.

Ensure service architecture activities support the development of a coherent and sustainable Technology Services operating model.

Standards, Methods and Tooling

Create, own and maintain Service Architecture standards, frameworks, templates, methods and guidance.

Define and govern the approaches used to design and assess services into operation.

Lead the development and adoption of tooling that supports Service Architecture practices.

Ensure consistent application of standards across services, programmes and portfolios.

Drive continual improvement of the Service Architecture capability across Technology Services.

Governance and Assurance

Provide assurance and expert challenge for complex, high-risk or strategically important services.

Oversee the quality and consistency of Service Architecture outputs across Technology Services.

Lead governance activities relating to service architecture, service design and operational readiness.

Ensure services are supportable, sustainable and capable of meeting operational requirements.

Identify and manage strategic risks associated with service design and service operation.

Stakeholder Leadership

Build strong relationships across architecture, engineering, product,

delivery, service management and operational communities.

Influence senior stakeholders on strategic service decisions and organisational priorities.

Act as the senior point of expertise for Service Architecture matters across Technology Services.

Support investment, procurement and transformation activity through expert service architecture leadership.

Promote end-to-end service thinking across the full service lifecycle.

If this feels like an exciting challenge, something you are enthusiastic about, and want to join our team please read on and apply!

Person Specification

Essential

Significant experience designing, assuring and improving complex technology services within large organisations.

Demonstrable experience working with strategic suppliers and commercial partners to design, govern and improve complex technology services.

Experience establishing and embedding standards, frameworks and governance processes.

Ability to influence senior stakeholders and drive organisational change without direct management authority.

Strong understanding of service design, service transition, service operations and continual improvement.

Experience developing, governing or improving service portfolios, service catalogues or service taxonomies.

Experience balancing user needs, organisational priorities and operational requirements.

Ability to provide assurance, challenge and strategic direction across multiple services, programmes or portfolios.

Excellent communication, stakeholder engagement and relationship-building skills.

Willingness to be assessed against the requirements for SC clearance.

We welcome the unique contribution diverse applicants bring and do not discriminate based on culture, ethnicity, race, nationality or national origin, age, sex, gender identity or expression, religion or belief, disability status, sexual orientation, educational or social background or any other factor.

Our values are Purpose, Humanity Openness and Together. Find out more [here](#) about how we celebrate diversity and an inclusive culture in our workplace.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan](#) and the [Civil Service D&I Strategy](#).

Salary Information**

Base salary for this role is from **London** - £75,674 to £85,257. National - £71,381 to £80,419.

New entrants to the Civil Service joining the MoJ are expected to start at the minimum of the pay band.

Existing Civil Servants moving on a level transfer will retain their current base salary or move to the minimum of the pay band for the role, whichever is higher.

Existing Civil Servants who are promoted will either move to the bottom of the new grade's pay band or receive a 10% uplift, whichever provides the greater increase.

Person specification

Please refer to Job Description

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £71,381, Ministry of Justice contributes £20,679 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Access to learning and development

A working environment that supports a range of flexible working options to enhance your work life balance

A working culture which encourages inclusion and diversity

A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Annual Leave

Public Holidays

Season Ticket Advance

For more information about the recruitment process, benefits and allowances and answers to general queries, please click the below link which will direct you to our Candidate Information Page.

Link: <https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ>

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

How to Apply

In Justice Digital, Data and Science, we recruit using the **Success Profiles** Framework. We shall assess a combination of your Experience and Behaviours during the assessment process.

Stage 1 - Application and sift:

To apply for this position, you must submit the following as part of your application:

A **CV** detailing your career history (including any relevant qualifications). Your CV will be assessed against the essential criteria outlined within the Person Specification of this advert.

A **Personal Statement** (no more than 750 words) which should outline your experience and skills, giving clear examples of work undertaken. It should specifically address the following criteria listed below which are being assessed at the sift stage, using a separate paragraph for each.

Significant experience designing, assuring and improving complex technology services within large organisations.

Demonstrable experience working with strategic suppliers and commercial partners to design, govern and improve complex technology services.

Experience establishing and embedding standards, frameworks and governance processes.

A diverse sift panel will review the information in your CV and Personal Statement to assess the sift criteria specified above. We operate an anonymous shortlisting process. Please ensure your CV and Personal Statement do not include your name or any other identifying details.

Should we receive a high volume of applications, a pre-sift based on the following criteria will be conducted before the sift -

Significant experience designing, assuring and improving complex technology services within large organisations.

Demonstrable experience working with strategic suppliers and commercial partners to design, govern and improve complex technology services.

Please access the following link for guidance on how to apply - [Application Guidance](#)

Stage 2 - Interviews:

Successful candidates who meet the required standard will then be invited to a panel interview held via Microsoft Teams. At interview stage, you will be

assessed against the following Success Profile elements - Experience, and the following Behaviours:

Seeing the Big Picture

Leadership

Communicating and Influencing

Working Together

As part of your interview, you will be asked to deliver a presentation that assesses your experience. Further details will be provided if successful at sift.

Appointments are made strictly in merit order. In the event that two or more candidates receive identical interview scores, the Significant experience designing, assuring and improving complex technology services within large organisations criterion will be applied as the primary lead criterion to determine the final merit order.

Should you be unsuccessful in the role that you have applied for but demonstrate the capability for a role at a lower level, we reserve the right to discuss this opportunity with you and offer you the position without needing a further application.

A reserve list may be held for up to 12 months, from which further appointments may be made.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	SSCL Recruitment Enquiries Team
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk
Telephone :	0345 241 5359
Recruitment team	
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel a department has breached the requirement of the Recruitment Principles and would like to raise this, please contact SSCL (Moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@gov.sscl.com) in the first instance. If the role has been advertised externally (outside of the Civil Service) and you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their web pages: <http://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/civil-service-recruitment/complaints/>

<https://www.jobtrain.co.uk/justicedigital/Job/JobDetail?JobId=1218>

